

True Match - Infrastructure & Scaling Guide

Your hosting services, free-tier limits, and when to upgrade as you grow.

1. Your subscriptions at a glance

You run on 5 services - 4 that can cost money, plus Telegram which is free.

Railway (main account)

- Runs: backend API + PostgreSQL database + Redis cache
- Current tier: Free Trial (one-time \$5 credit) - nearly used up
- Ceiling: after 30 days or \$5 spent it drops to Free (\$1/mo credit - not enough to stay online)
- Next: Hobby \$5/mo (includes \$5 usage), then Pro \$20/mo

Railway (2nd account)

- Runs: the CardXabar userbot
- Current tier: Free Trial
- Next: Hobby \$5/mo, OR move it to a free Oracle Cloud VM to avoid the cost

Vercel

- Runs: the frontend (Telegram Mini App)
- Current tier: Hobby (free)
- Ceiling: 100 GB bandwidth/mo, 1M requests - and Hobby is NON-COMMERCIAL use only
- Next: Pro \$20/mo (required for a paid/commercial app)

Cloudflare R2

- Runs: user photo storage
- Current tier: Free
- Ceiling: 10 GB storage, 10M reads/mo, ZERO egress fees
- Next: pay-as-you-go, ~\$0.015/GB/mo (pennies)

Telegram

- Runs: the bot + Stars payments
- Free forever. Only limit is ~30 messages/sec on the Bot API. No plan to buy.

2. Two things to act on NOW (not user-count related)

a) Railway main trial is basically expired

When the credit hits \$0 it drops to the Free plan (\$1/mo), which will not keep your backend + database running - the app goes offline. Upgrade the main Railway account to Hobby (\$5/mo) very soon. With real usage counted, the 3 services running 24/7 will cost roughly \$8-15/mo total.

b) Vercel Hobby forbids commercial use

Their policy: Hobby is for non-commercial personal use only; commercial apps need Pro or Enterprise. You charge for Premium, so you are commercial. You are unlikely to be flagged

while tiny, but plan to move to Pro (\$20/mo) once you have paying users to avoid a takedown.

3. When to upgrade, by user count

Rough milestones - they depend on how active and photo-heavy your users are.

Now (0-100 users)

- Trial ending: move Railway main to Hobby \$5/mo (keeps you alive).
- Userbot: Hobby \$5/mo, or move to a free Oracle VM.

~500-1,000 active users

- More traffic + DB rows + Redis; Railway usage ~\$15-30/mo -> consider Pro \$20/mo.
- Move Vercel to Pro \$20/mo once you are earning.

~2,000-4,000 users with photos

- R2 crosses 10 GB (about 3-6 MB of photos per user). Cost is pennies (~\$1/mo for 60 GB).

~5,000-10,000+ users

- Database becomes the bottleneck. Add connection pooling (PgBouncer), bump Postgres memory,
- put a Cloudflare CDN in front of R2, and batch bot notifications (30 msg/sec limit).

4. Realistic cost trajectory

- Today (live & safe): ~\$5-15/mo (Railway main Hobby; userbot free on Oracle or +\$5 Railway)
- Hundreds of paying users: ~\$45-60/mo (Railway Pro \$20 + Vercel Pro \$20 + R2 a few \$)
- Thousands of users: ~\$80-150/mo + a managed Postgres when you outgrow Railway's

5. Recommendation right now

- 1) Upgrade Railway (main) to Hobby \$5/mo today - this is the one that takes the app offline if ignored.
- 2) Userbot: cheapest is a free Oracle VM; or pay \$5/mo on Railway for simplicity.
- 3) R2 and Telegram: ignore for a long time - they scale to thousands of users nearly free.
- 4) Vercel: fine for now; switch to Pro once real revenue starts.

Prices from Railway, Vercel and Cloudflare R2 official docs (2026). Estimates only; actual cost depends on your real traffic and data. Generated for True Match.